College of Massage Therapists of Ontario

Massage Matters

April 2024

College of Massage Therapists of Ontario

CMTO Releases 2023 Annual Report

We are pleased to announce the release of CMTO's 2023 Annual Report.

Over the past year, CMTO started the work on its new multi-year Strategic Plan (2023-25). Our dedicated team, with oversight from CMTO's Board, made progress in key areas of the plan:

- **Sexual Abuse Prevention**. CMTO held its first Prevention of Sexual Abuse Symposium. The new event brought together educators, client advocates and other regulators to discuss the prevention of sexual abuse in Massage Therapy.

- **Engagement and Partnerships.** We continued collaborating with our health system partners on the innovative Health Professions Discipline Tribunals Pilot (HPDTP). We also held several Open House events across Ontario to provide regulatory updates, and learn from RMTs about the issues impacting Massage Therapy practice.

- **Regulatory Excellence.** In 2023, CMTO introduced a new Risk-based Assessment as part of STRiVE, CMTO's Quality Assurance Program.

- **Equity, Diversity and Inclusion (EDI).** CMTO advanced its commitment to promoting EDI principles in the Massage Therapy profession by forming a permanent EDI Standing Committee for the College.

We invite you to read our new Annual Report to learn more about CMTO's work and strategic initiatives for 2023.

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Five Things to Know Before Booking a Massage

Have you tried Massage Therapy before? If you have, you know Massage Therapy has many benefits, like pain relief and relaxation.

But if you haven't experienced Massage Therapy for yourself, you might wonder what to expect from your first appointment. Whether you are new to Massage Therapy or a long-time client, here are five things you should keep in mind before seeing a Registered Massage Therapist (RMT) in Ontario.

1. **Massage Therapy is healthcare.** Whether received at a health clinic, sporting event, spa or home clinic, Massage Therapy is healthcare and RMTs are regulated health professionals who are overseen by CMTO.

2. **Your health history matters**. Your RMT will collect personal health information about your general health, medications, and any preexisting health conditions, to provide you with the best possible care. Only information needed to provide safe and effective Massage Therapy treatment can be collected, but you can choose not to share information too if you aren't comfortable. RMTs will ensure that all client records are kept in compliance with CMTO's Record Keeping Requirements.

3. **You stay in control of your care**. RMTs will ask for your consent before starting treatment or making any changes to your treatment plan. As a client, you have the right to ask your RMT to stop, modify, or explain your treatment – at any time, for any reason.

4. **Feel covered and safe**. You should always feel comfortable and safe during your treatment. For example, you can decide how much clothing to remove, or request the pressure level that feels right for you.

5. **Always look before you book**. To take full advantage of everything Massage Therapy can offer, it's important that you visit an RMT. They are regulated health professionals who have met high educational standards, are required to adhere to professional standards and rules, and their conduct is overseen by CMTO. Use CMTO's Find an RMT tool to verify that the person you intend to see is a qualified RMT.

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To learn more, check out CMTO's video about 5 Things You Need to Know Before Getting a Massage.

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Don't Forget to Look Before You Book!

Are you interested in booking a massage, but aren't sure where to start?

We can help!

CMTO has a tool called Find an RMT to help you find a Registered Massage Therapist (RMT or MT) anywhere in Ontario.

CMTO isn't a school, but a regulatory body that oversees RMTs across Ontario. CMTO exists to ensure you receive safe, quality and ethical Massage Therapy treatment every time.

By using the **Find an RMT** tool, you can verify the following details about any RMT/MT practising in Ontario:

- contact information;
- practice location;
- registration details;
- languages spoken; and
- conduct history.

By looking before you book, you can ensure you're seeing a qualified, educated, and highly trained health professional, who is registered with CMTO!

For more information, please visit www.cmto.com/lookbeforeyoubook/.

Have a question or feedback for CMTO about your Massage Therapy treatment? Don't hesitate to reach out to us at cmto@cmto.com.

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Becoming an RMT in Ontario

Practising as a Registered Massage Therapist (RMT/MT) in Ontario is a privilege that offers the opportunity to enrich the lives of Ontarians through quality and ethical care.

All RMTs practising in Ontario have received a high-quality education, completed mandatory examinations, and continue to meet professional standards and requirements through CTMO's annual Quality Assurance Program, called "STRiVE".

If you or someone you know is considering a career in Massage Therapy, we have outlined a helpful step-by-step process guide below.

Step 1: Meet the educational requirements.
Whether an applicant lives in Ontario, or has moved from a different province or country, there are certain educational criteria that aspiring candidates will have to meet before qualifying for CMTO's mandatory exams. Our website provides different application paths based on unique situations.

Step 2: Pass CMTO's certification examinations.
To ensure all new applicants have the required skills and knowledge to enter the Massage Therapy profession, CMTO requires candidates to complete two mandatory certification exams:

- The **Multiple-Choice Questionnaire (MCQ**) examination: a computer-based exam consisting of 150 questions; and
- The **Objectively Structured Clinical Evaluation (OSCE)**: a hands-on clinical exam designed to test the candidate's knowledge and skill application using clinical scenarios in simulated real-life test stations.

Step 3: Complete CMTO's Jurisprudence Program.
When the candidates have completed the MCQ and OSCE exams, they will be asked to participate in CMTO's Jurisprudence Program. The program focuses on the prevention of sexual abuse, Standards of Practice, legislation and expectations on maintaining professional boundaries and ethics. For more information about the program, check out CMTO's video.

Step 4: Submit an Initial Registration application.
As the final step in the application process, candidates will be asked to complete an application form, which will include the submission of supporting documents

and payment of an application and the annual registration fee. Once an applicant is approved and allowed to practise as an RMT, they will be required to maintain their knowledge and understanding of Massage Therapy through their yearly participation in STRiVE and complete the annual registration renewal.

By following the above steps, RMTs can embark on a fulfilling career dedicated to improving and maintaining the health of Ontarians.

For more information on how to apply for registration, please visit CMTO's website.